

Characterizing Vocal Behaviour and Culture of Male Sperm Whales

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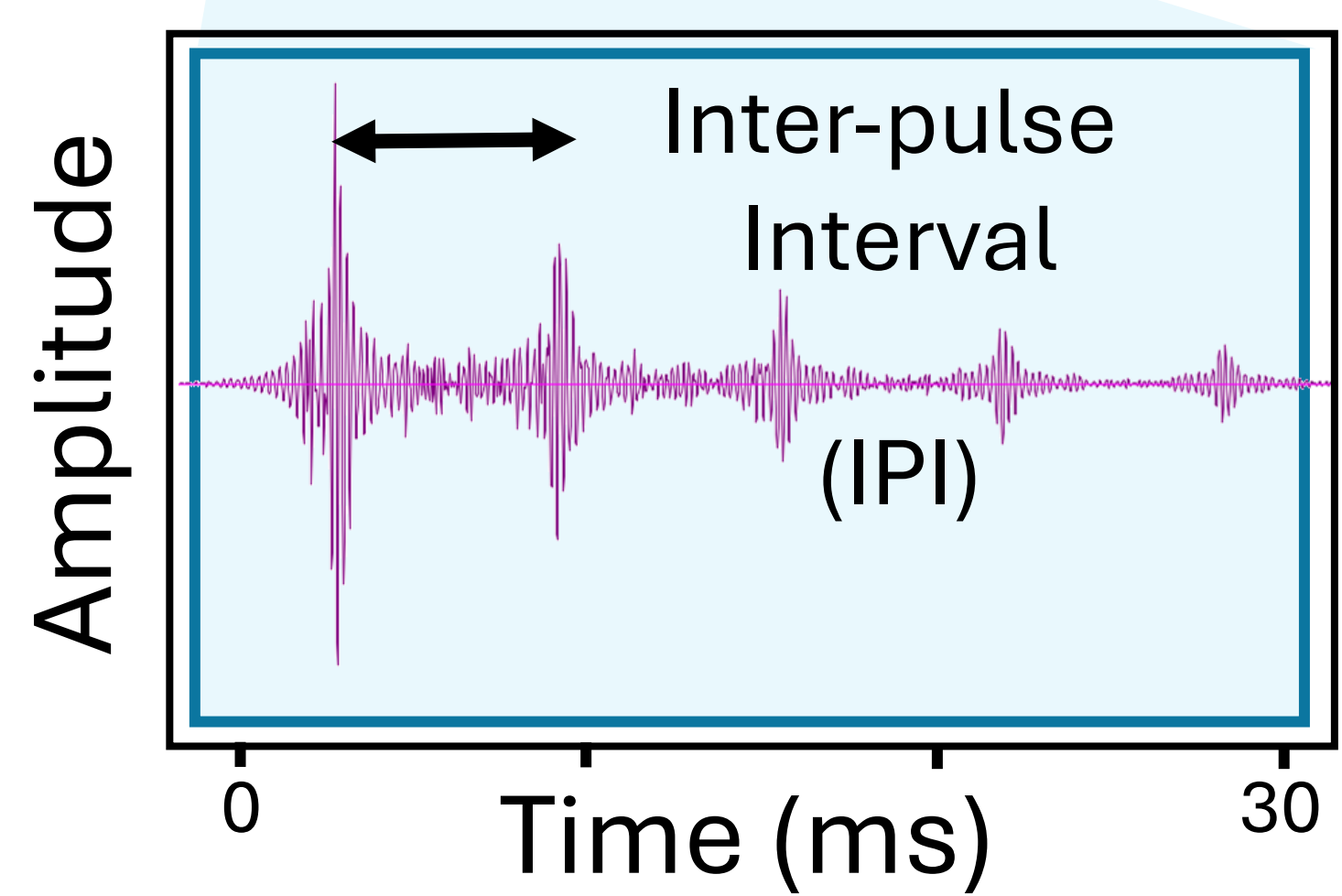
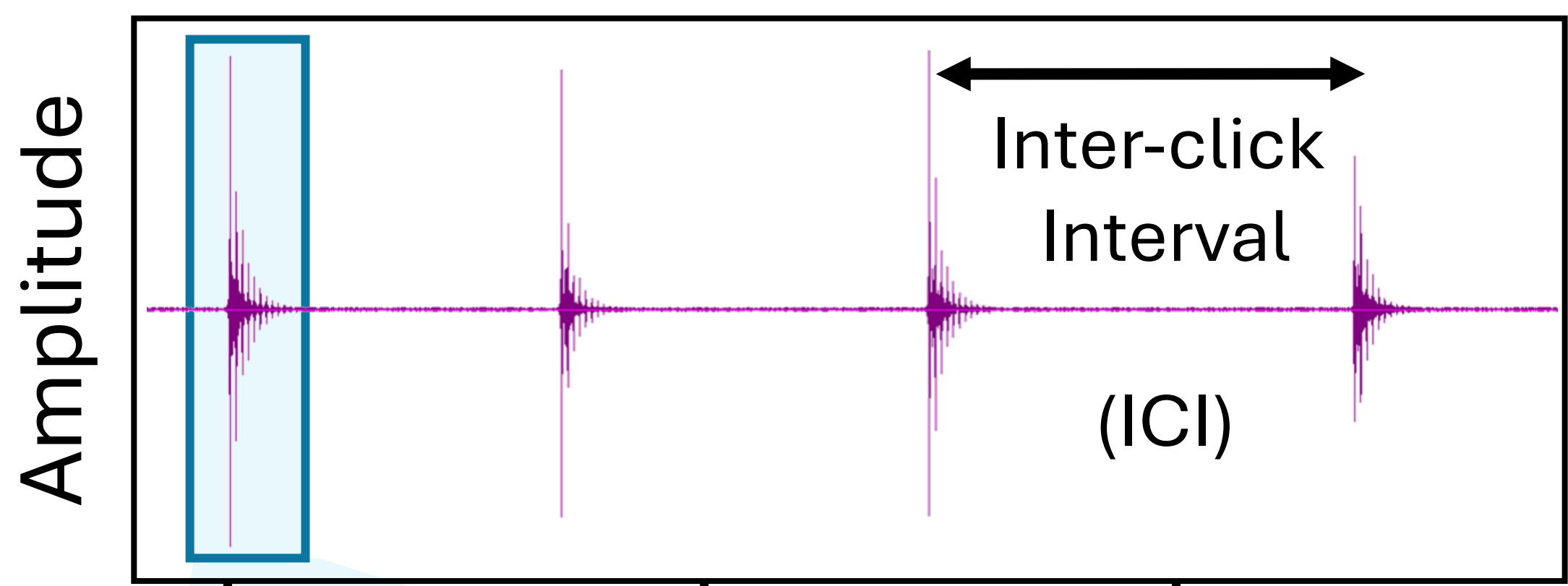
Context

Male sperm whales are raised in families where culture is a cornerstone that shapes their lives. But what is the role of culture, and who do they learn from, after they mature and set out on their own?

Approach

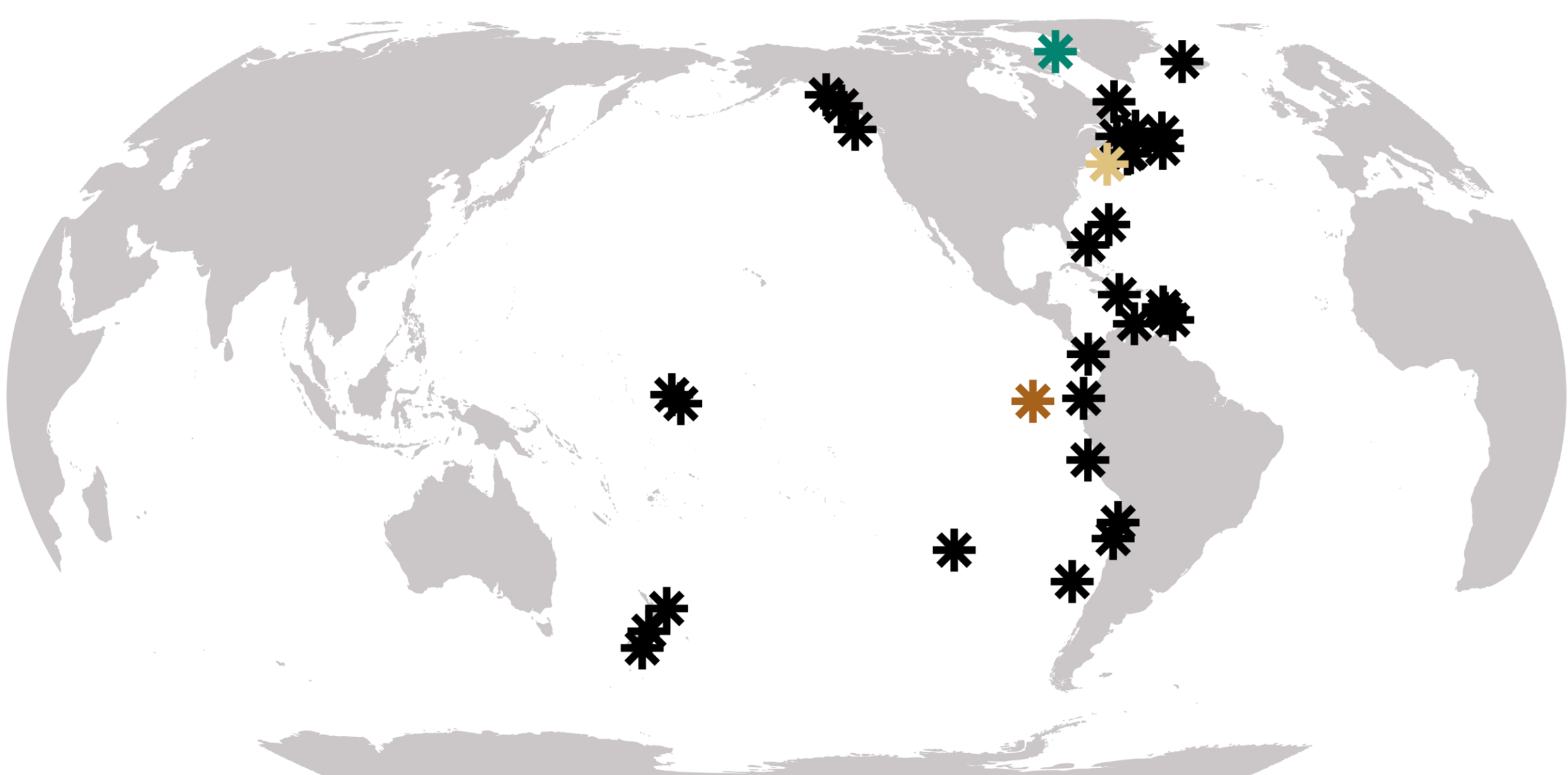
We are characterizing male sperm whales' repertoires of codas (call type made by both sexes and used to define vocal clans) and slow clicks (male-only call type).

Coda of 14 m male Galapagos 2023



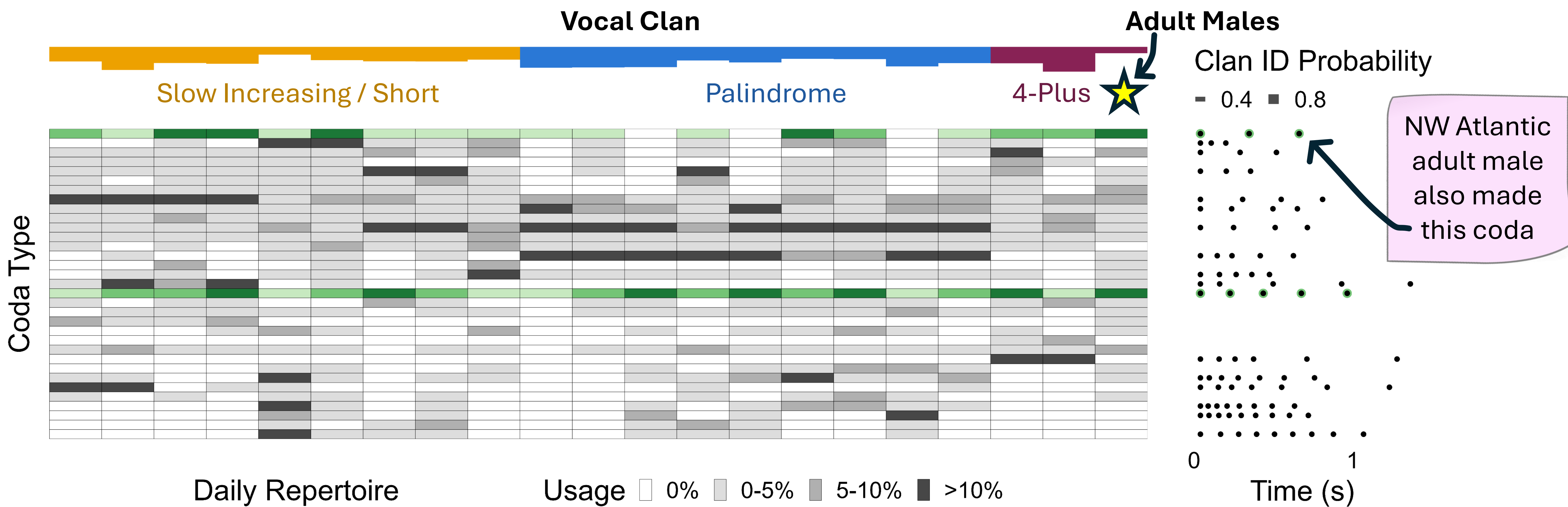
IPI scales with body length. Adult males' codas have IPIs > 5 ms.

Recording Locations

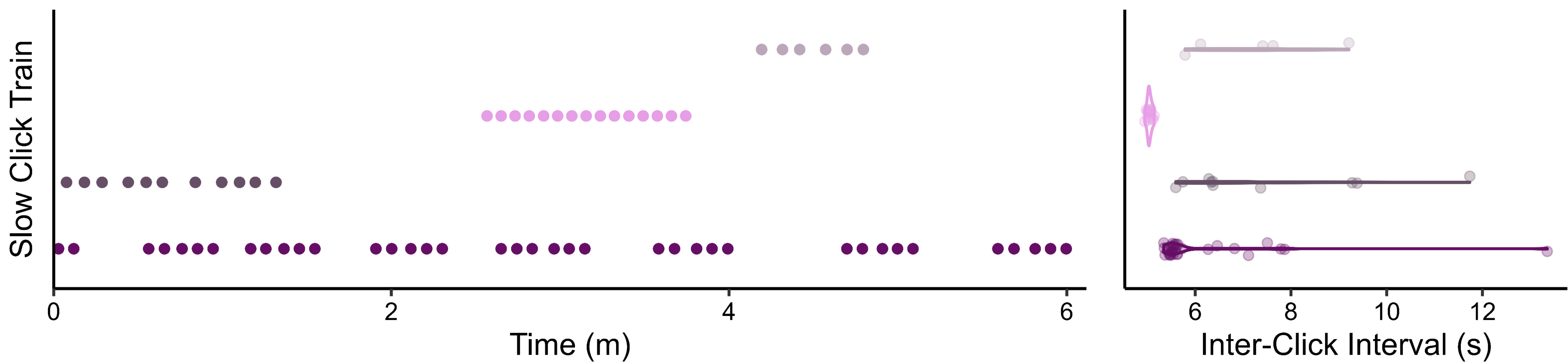


Have recordings in a place I don't?
Let's talk!

Adult males make **codas common across vocal clans**, suggesting they may not conform to any one clan dialect * Galapagos 2023



Multiple males make slow clicks concurrently using different timings and bout durations, some with coda-like patterns * Fundian Channel, Sep. 2023



Also, overlapping slow click trains of varying ICIs heard off * Galapagos and * Baffin Bay. Thus, variation in slow click use cannot be explained by season and location.

Next steps

As we add to our global datasets of males' codas and slow clicks, we'll test for evidence of social learning and cultural groups among male sperm whales.

Follow along, contribute or learn more

